

5. Rule of Law (RL)

Rule of Law (RL) captures perceptions of the extent to which agents respect and follow the rules of society, including contract enforcement, property rights, the police, courts, and the likelihood of crime and violence.

The table below lists the individual indicators drawn from each underlying data source and incorporated into the revised WGI. These indicators represent the specific questions or variables used to estimate the RL governance scores for the most recent year available. In some cases, question wording differs in earlier years, and three data sources have been discontinued (but continue to be used in the calculation of governance measures for the past years in which they were available). Users should consult the WGI website for a [complete list](#) of source-specific data files containing all historical indicators.

Before the data are used in the aggregation model, each question or variable is rescaled to range from 0 to 1, with higher values corresponding to better governance outcomes. When a data source includes multiple questions or variables related to the same dimension, the rescaled values are averaged to produce a single source–dimension input prior to aggregation. This ensures that each source contributes only one signal per dimension and prevents data providers with more questions from being given undue weight.

Representative Sources

Code	Question or Variable
EIU	Accountability of public officials
	Confiscation/expropriation
	Enforceability of contracts
	Fairness of judicial process
	Human rights
	Organised crime
	Protection of intellectual property rights
	Protection of private property
	Speediness of judicial process
	Violent crime
FRH	Civil Liberties - Rule of Law (FRW)
	Judicial Framework and Independence (NIT)
GCS	Business costs of crime and violence
	Intellectual Property Protection
	Judicial Independence
	Organized crime
GWP	Property Rights
	Question 40A. Have you had money property stolen from you or another household member (% YES)
	Question 40D. Have you been assaulted or mugged (% YES)
	WP112 Confidence in local police force (% YES)
PRS	WP138 Confidence in Judicial System (% YES)
	Investment Profile - Contract Viability
VDM	Law and Order
	Liberal Component Index (v2x_liberal)

Code	Question or Variable
WMO	Contract enforcement Expropriation State contract alteration

Non-representative Sources

Code	Question or Variable
ADB	Property Rights and Rule Based Governance
AFR	How often feared crime in home Trust Police Trust courts of law
ARB	Do robberies happen frequently, sometimes, rarely, or never in your neighborhood? Do street violence and fights happen frequently, sometimes, rarely, or never in your neighborhood? How much trust you have in courts and legal system? How would you evaluate the current government's performance on providing security and order? How would you rate the safety of your neighborhood?
ASB	Access to Public Service: Help from the police when you need it Access to Public Service: how safe is living in this city/ town/ village Quality of Governance: How capable is the government of enforcing laws and implementing policies? Quality of Governance: How often do you think government leaders break the law or abuse their power? Quality of Governance: Rich and poor people are treated equally by the government. Quality of Governance: When government leaders break the laws, there is nothing the court can do Trust in Institutions: The Courts Trust in Institutions: The Police
ASD	Property Rights and Rule-Based Governance
BPS	Constraint: Crime Constraint: Judiciary Fair and honest courts
BTI	Rule of Law
CCR	Rule of Law
EQI	Quality of Police Force
EUB	Trust in justice and the legal system Trust in police
GII	In practice, allegations of corruption against senior level politicians and/or civil servants of any level are investigated by an independent body. In practice, appointments to the supreme audit institution support the independence of the agency. In practice, national-level judges appointments (justices or magistrates) support the independence of the judiciary. In practice, national-level judges give reasons for their decisions/judgments. In practice, the independence of the judiciary is guaranteed. In practice, the independence of the supreme audit institution is guaranteed. In practice, the mechanism for citizens to report police misconduct or abuse of force is effective. In practice, the supreme audit agency releases frequent reports that are accessible to citizens.
HRM	Right to Freedom from Arbitrary Political Arrest Right to Freedom from Disappearance

Code	Question or Variable
	Right to Freedom from Extrajudicial Execution
	Right to Freedom from Torture and Ill-Treatment
IFD	Access to land
	Access to water
IJT	Crime
LBO	Trust in Judiciary
	Trust in Police
	Victim of Crime
PIA	Property Rights and Rule-based Governance
VAB	Trust in justice
	Trust in police
	Trust in supreme court
	Victim of crime
WBS	crime8 Crime as an obstacle
	crime9 Courts as an obstacle
	disp3 Courts independence
	disp4 Arbitration as a reliable alternative
	disp5 Mediation as a reliable alternative
WCY	Intellectual property rights are adequately enforced
	Justice is fairly administered
WJP	Factor 1: Constraints on Government Powers
	Factor 4: Fundamental Rights
	Factor 5.1: Crime is effectively controlled (Order and Security)
	Factor 7: Civil Justice
	Factor 8: Criminal Justice

Code	Organization	Data Source
ADB	African Development Bank	Country Policy and Institutional Assessment
AFR	Afrobarometer	Afrobarometer Surveys
ARB	Arab Barometer	Arab Barometer Surveys
ASB	Asian Barometer	Asian Barometer Survey
ASD	Asian Development Bank	Country Performance Assessment
BPS	World Bank; European Bank for Reconstruction and Development	Business Environment and Enterprise Performance Survey (BEEPS)
BTI	Bertelsmann Foundation	Bertelsmann Transformation Index
CCR	Freedom House	Countries at the Crossroads
EBR	European Bank for Reconstruction and Development	Transition Indicators
EIU	Economist Intelligence Unit	Operational Risk Service; Democracy Index
EQI	Quality of Governance Institute at University of Gothenburg	European Quality of Governance Index
EUB	European Union	Eurobarometer
FRH	Freedom House	Freedom in the World; Freedom of the Net; Nations in Transit
GCB	Transparency International	Global Corruption Barometer
GCS	World Economic Forum	Executive Opinion Survey
GII	African Institute for Development Policy	Africa Integrity Indicators
GWP	Gallup	Gallup World Poll
HER	Heritage Foundation	Index of Economic Freedom
HRM	Human Rights Measurement Initiative	Rights Tracker
HUM	University of North Carolina-Asheville	Political Terror Scale
IFD	International Fund for Agricultural Development	Rural Sector Performance Assessment
IJT	Crisis24	Country Security Assessment Ratings
IRP	Ghana Center for Democratic Development	African Electoral Integrity Index
LBO	Latinobarometro	Latinobarometro
MSI	International Research and Exchanges Board	Vibrant Information Barometer
OBI	International Budget Partnership	Open Budget Survey
PIA	World Bank	Country Policy and Institutional Assessment
PRS	The PRS Group	International Country Risk Guide
RSF	Reporters Without Borders	Press Freedom Index
VAB	Center for Global Democracy at Vanderbilt University	Americas Barometer Survey
VDM	Varieties of Democracy Institute	Varieties of Democracy
WBS	World Bank	Enterprise Surveys
WCY	Institute for Management Development (IMD)	World Competitiveness Report Survey
WJP	World Justice Project	Rule of Law Index
WMO	S&P Global	Country Risk Scores